BNSS — Previous Year Question Paper Analysis

BNSS (Criminal Procedure), Juvenile Justice & Probation of Offenders · Osmania University LLB (3 YDC) Sem V · **2013–2021**

Companion to the **BNSS Previous Year Question Papers** and the **BNSS Story Notes** · by **lawsticker-ai.com**

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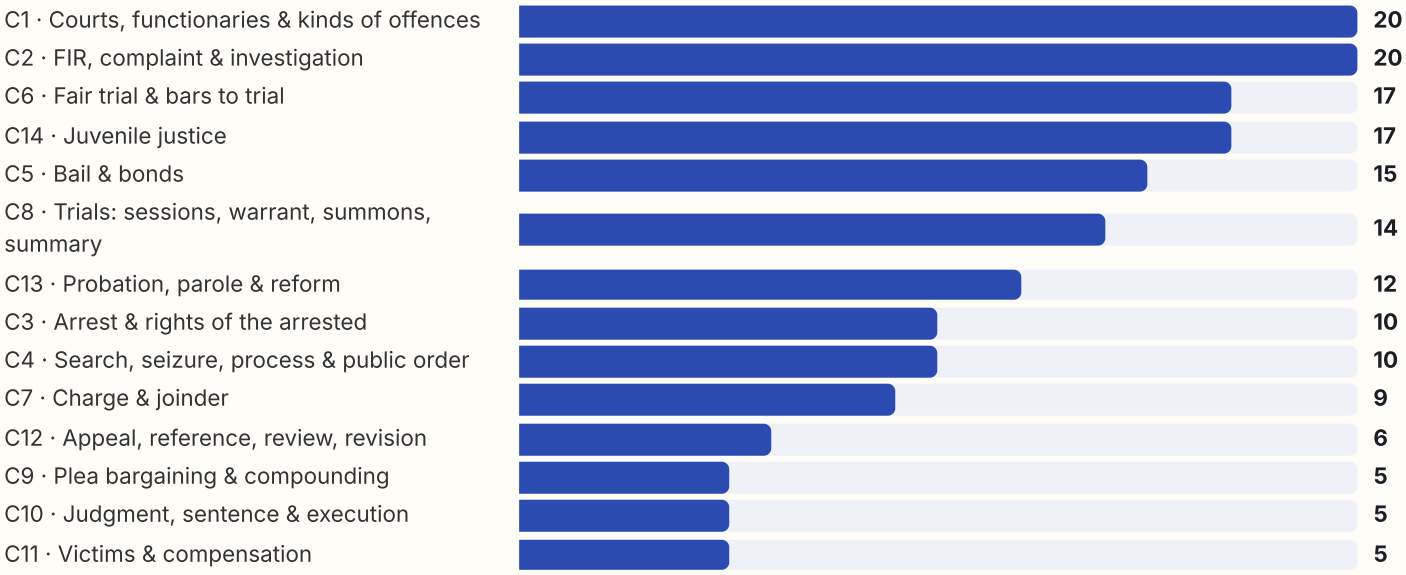
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11	165	14	7
sittings	questions	topic clusters	Tier 1 clusters

Key findings

1. **Unit V (juvenile justice + probation) appears in every one of the 10 full papers** — 29 questions, and a **Unit V essay in 9 of 10 full papers** (usually Q12: JJ Act features / rehabilitation, or the Probation of Offenders Act).
2. **FIR & investigation (20) and the basics — police, courts, kinds of offences (20)** — are asked in **every one of the 10 full papers**, mostly as short notes.
3. **Trials are the favourite essay** — a Part B question on sessions / warrant / summons / summary trial in **7 of 11 papers** (10 essays in all).
4. **Part C loves juveniles, bail and arrest** — 7 juvenile problems, 8 bail problems, 4 arrest problems (three of them on arresting a judge) and 6 on charge / joinder.
5. **Fair trial & double jeopardy is rising** — 16 questions since 2016 against 1 before.

Questions per cluster — all sittings, 2013–2021



Cluster × part — and how many papers asked it

Cluster	Unit	Tier	A	B	C	Total	Asked in (of 10)	Story Notes
C1 Courts, functionaries & kinds of offences	I	T1	17	1	2	**20**	10 (100%)	Ch 0
C2 FIR, complaint & investigation	I	T1	9	5	6	**20**	10 (100%)	Ch 1, 4
C6 Fair trial & bars to trial	III	T1	11	2	4	**17**	8 (80%)	Ch 7, 8
C14 Juvenile justice	V	T1	4	6	7	**17**	9 (90%)	Ch 15
C5 Bail & bonds	II	T1	4	3	8	**15**	7 (70%)	Ch 5
C8 Trials: sessions, warrant, summons, summary	III–IV	T1	4	10	0	**14**	7 (70%)	Ch 9, 10
C13 Probation, parole & reform	V	T1	6	4	2	**12**	9 (90%)	Ch 14
C3 Arrest & rights of the arrested	I–II	T2	4	2	4	**10**	8 (80%)	Ch 2
C4 Search, seizure, process & public order	I–II	T2	5	5	0	**10**	8 (80%)	Ch 3, 6
C7 Charge & joinder	III	T2	1	2	6	**9**	7 (70%)	Ch 9
C12 Appeal, reference, review, revision	IV	T3	6	0	0	**6**	6 (60%)	Ch 13
C9 Plea bargaining & compounding	IV	T3	3	0	2	**5**	4 (40%)	Ch 10
C10 Judgment, sentence & execution	IV	T3	4	0	1	**5**	5 (50%)	Ch 11, 14
C11 Victims & compensation	IV	T3	3	0	2	**5**	4 (40%)	Ch 12

A = short note · **B** = essay · **C** = problem. 'Asked in' counts only the **10 papers** where Parts A, B and C are all available. **Tier** = average questions per paper: **T1** one or more, **T2** 0.6 to 1, **T3** fewer. **Story Notes** = the chapter of the BNSS Story Notes that teaches the topic.

Trend by period

Cluster	2013–15 (4)	2016–20 (5)	2021+ (2)	Trend (per paper)
C1 Courts, functionaries & kinds of offences	8	9	3	● steady
C2 FIR, complaint & investigation	6	9	5	▲ more often lately
C6 Fair trial & bars to trial	1	9	7	▲ more often lately
C14 Juvenile justice	4	9	4	● steady
C5 Bail & bonds	10	2	3	● steady
C8 Trials: sessions, warrant, summons, summary	3	9	2	● steady
C13 Probation, parole & reform	5	5	2	● steady
C3 Arrest & rights of the arrested	3	6	1	▼ less often lately
C4 Search, seizure, process & public order	4	4	2	● steady
C7 Charge & joinder	3	4	2	● steady
C12 Appeal, reference, review, revision	2	3	1	● steady
C9 Plea bargaining & compounding	0	5	0	▼ less often lately
C10 Judgment, sentence & execution	2	2	1	● steady
C11 Victims & compensation	1	4	0	▼ less often lately

*Number of sittings in brackets. The trend compares questions **per paper** in 2021+ with the earlier years, so a period with fewer papers isn't marked down just for being smaller.*

Questions that keep coming back

Question (same idea)	Asked in	Cluster · key law
Can the police arrest a judge? (murder / corruption)	May/June 2016 · Jan 2019 · Jan 2020	C3 · arrest with prior intimation, Delhi Judicial Service Assn.
Husband poisons wife, first offence — probation?	2013 · Jan 2019	C13 · PO Act S.4 not for offences punishable with death / life
Bail continues after a fresh offence on bail?	2013 · undated (Code 1026)	C5 · cancellation of bail
Under-trial granted bail but too poor to furnish bond	2014 · Dec 2015 · undated (Code 1026)	C5 · personal bond, S.436A / Hussainara Khatoon
Cruelty / dowry case — guilty plea to cut the sentence (plea bargaining)	May/June 2016 · Jan/Feb 2017	C9 · plea bargaining barred for offences against women
Three offences within a year — which court, joint trial?	Dec 2015 · May/June 2016	C7 · S.219 CrPC / S.242 BNSS
Retrial after acquittal / same facts, different offence	Jan/Feb 2017 · 2018 · Jan 2019 · Feb 2021 · undated common	C6 · Art. 20(2), S.300 CrPC / S.337 BNSS
Juvenile's age — offence under 18, trial after 18	May/June 2016 · 2018 · Feb 2021 · undated common	C14 · age on the date of offence decides
Sessions trial procedure (essay)	Dec 2015 · May/June 2016 · 2018 · Jan 2020 · undated common	C8 · S.248–260 BNSS
FIR — law, evidential value, v complaint (essay)	2013 · Dec 2015 · Jan/Feb 2017 · Jan 2019 · undated common	C2 · S.173 BNSS, Lalita Kumari
Salient features of the JJ Act / rehabilitation (essay)	2013 · Dec 2015 · 2016 · 2017 · Jan 2020 · undated common	C14

What to do with this

- **Tier 1** = C1, C2, C6, C14, C5, C8, C13 — prepare a full essay and the repeat problems for each.
- **Tier 2** = C3, C4, C7 — essay outline + short notes. **Tier 3** = C12, C9, C10, C11 — short-note level.
- In Part B, keep **one Unit V essay** (JJ Act features / rehabilitation **or** PO Act) and **one trial essay** (sessions trial) ready; **FIR** and **search & seizure / S.144 validity** are the next most likely.
- For Part C, practise the **repeat problems** above — juvenile age, arrest of a judge, bail after a fresh offence, the poor under-trial, retrial after acquittal and plea bargaining in offences against women.
- Older papers quote **CrPC** sections; in the exam write the **BNSS section first and the CrPC section in brackets** (e.g. FIR — S.173 BNSS / S.154 CrPC).

Sources & how sure we are

- **Full text 2013–2020**: lawsticker-ai.com previous-year-question archive (3 YDC papers). Copies of the same papers online show they were **common papers** for 3 YDC Sem V and 5 YDC Sem IX.
- **February 2021** and the **undated common paper**: Studocu (Osmania University collections). Their headers read **'LL.B (3 YDC) … V Semester'** together with **'B.LL (5 YDC) IX Semester'** — i.e. common papers. The undated paper's exact sitting is not printed on the copy.
- **Undated Code 1026**: only Part C is visible and the header is cut off; the questions are plainly this subject.
- No paper from **2022 (dated), 2023, 2024 or 2025** was publicly available. Papers from **2024 onward** are set on the **BNSS** (which replaced the CrPC from 1 July 2024); older papers cite CrPC sections — the topics are the same.
- This report shows what **has** been asked — it is **not a prediction** of what will be asked.

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